

AI that reads the fine print for you. **Generative AI · Social Impact**

Paste any dense document and get it back in **plain words**, the clauses that **affect you** ranked by severity, and the **questions to ask** before you sign.

LIVE plainspeak-nine.vercel.app · REPO github.com/OrionArchitekton/plainspeak (MIT) · VIDEO youtu.be/EbHJ4gQpNS8

01 The problem

Ordinary people sign leases, accept medical plans, and click *I agree* on terms they do not actually understand. The language is written to be understood by the party that wrote it, not the person it affects. That asymmetry quietly costs people money, rights, and peace of mind. Plainspeak closes the comprehension gap, and does it in a way that respects the reader: it tells you what affects *you*, not just a generic summary.

02 How it works

One Next.js app, one server route, one structured model call. The Anthropic API key never reaches the browser; the model is constrained by a system prompt and a JSON contract, and the reply is parsed defensively so a malformed response degrades gracefully instead of crashing.

```
Browser  Next.js 15 / React 19
| POST /api/explain { document, readingLevel, situation }
▼
Server route (nodejs runtime · key stays server-side · optional per-IP rate limit)
| system prompt = persona + reading level + "not legal/medical advice" guardrail + JSON contract
▼
Anthropic Claude  claude-sonnet-4-6 · temperature 0 (deterministic, repeatable)
| reply → defensive JSON parse (recovers code-fenced / messy) → sort clauses high→low
▼
Three cards  In plain words · What affects you (ranked) · Questions to ask
```

03 The output that matters

Not a summary, three answers. The middle one is the differentiator: the specific clauses that affect the reader, ranked so the traps surface first.

HIGH

Your \$4,800 deposit is non-refundable if you leave before 12 months, even with no damage.

MEDIUM

Rent can jump 12% at renewal with only 30 days' notice, less than the 60 you need to leave.

LOW

The landlord may enter with 24 hours' notice; the document never defines valid notice.

Then the exact questions to ask the landlord, clinician, or company, so the reader walks in informed instead of intimidated. Reading level is a control: *Like I'm 10, Plain English, or Full detail.*

04 Safe and deterministic by construction

- **Guardrail in the model's own instructions** — "never invent facts; this is not professional advice." The UI repeats it.
- **Temperature 0** — the same document yields the same explanation, every time.
- **No persistence** — documents are processed and returned, never stored. The only write is an optional rate-limit counter (IP + count), never content.

05 Engineering rigor

The prompt-build and parse logic is a pure module, unit-tested without a network. The build is verified live, not just compiled, and every load-bearing claim survived an independent adversarial review before submission.

Next.js 15

React 19

TypeScript

Tailwind v4

Anthropic Claude

@anthropic-ai/sdk

Vercel

Upstash Redis

Vitest · 11 tests

Shaped by adversarial review

"You say clauses are 'ranked by severity', but nothing sorts them."

Correct. Added a stable high → medium → low sort in the parser, so the claim is true on the live path, not just in the demo fixture.

"The rate limit shipped but never returns 429."

Vercel's Upstash integration injects `KV_REST_API_*`, not `UPSTASH_REDIS_REST_*`. The limiter now accepts both, **verified returning 429 under a concurrent burst**.

06 Try it in 60 seconds

1 • Open	<code>plainspeak-nine.vercel.app</code>
2 • One click	Hit the Apartment lease example (a real, trap-laden lease loads).
3 • Make it plain	In a few seconds: the plain explanation, the high/medium/low clauses, and the questions to ask.
4 • Bring your own	Paste a medical letter or a terms-of-service and set "your situation" to see it tailored.

plainspeak-nine.vercel.app · github.com/OrionArchitekton/plainspeak · built end to end by Claude Code (Anthropic's agentic CLI) for the FutureAI Global Hackathon 2026